

Marketing and Market Research

Business Projects



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Course synopsis

- Capstone-style course for students specializing in International Business
- Core task: develop a comprehensive international marketing plan
- Marketing and marketing research at the core: investigate markets systematically and evaluate opportunities and risks
- Emphasis on critical thinking, project management and teamwork in a multicultural context
- Outcome: a structured international marketing plan with evidence-based strategic recommendations

Learning objectives

- Design and present a structured international marketing plan based on systematic analysis and research
- Apply marketing concepts internationally and evaluate opportunities and risks across markets
- Conduct and interpret marketing research for evidence-based decisions
- Analyze competition, customer needs and cultural influences
- Strengthen teamwork, project management and intercultural collaboration
- Communicate complex ideas clearly and persuasively, in writing and orally
- Develop creativity and problem-solving to propose innovative, feasible strategies

Teaching and learning: flipped classroom

Before class

- Independent research on key concepts and methods
- Preparation for the next session's task
- Self-directed learning

In class

- Discussion and application
- Coaching sessions and progress reports
- Peer feedback
- Theory directly connected to the project task

The Julius Meinl case



Marketing plan for entering Latin America

Our partner: Julius Meinl

- Family-owned Viennese coffee roaster, founded in 1862, now in its fifth generation
- Present in more than 70 countries, mostly through local distribution partners
- Customers in hospitality (HoReCa: cafés, restaurants, hotels) and in grocery retail
- No own sales organisation in export markets
- Success depends heavily on the local partner and on how well the brand is positioned in the market

The question: growth in Latin America

- Julius Meinl sees Latin America (South America and Mexico) as a potential future growth region, where it is currently not present or only marginally
- Which Latin American markets are attractive?
- How could market entry look?
- How should the brand be marketed?

Central question: Many Latin American countries grow and roast their own coffee and have a strong coffee culture. Why would cafés, hotels, retailers and consumers choose a coffee brand from Vienna, and who exactly would do so?

Six markets, one set of criteria

Markets compared by all groups

- Argentina
- Brazil
- Chile
- Colombia
- Mexico
- Uruguay

Example criteria

- Size of the premium coffee segment (HoReCa and retail)
- Tourism and international hotel presence
- Purchasing power and economic development
- Competitive landscape
- Import conditions and regulation
- Coffee culture and consumption habits

Three group presentations



Content, midterm and final presentation

Overview of the presentations

Presentation	Length	Weight	Focus
1 Content presentation	15 min	20 %	Market selection tools: theory, real-world applications, pitfalls
2 Midterm presentation	20 min	30 %	Market selection and competitor analysis
3 Final presentation	25 min	30 %	Marketing implementation plan

Presentation 1: market selection tools

- Review the tools companies use to screen, compare and select international markets
- Cover the theory, real-world applications and typical pitfalls (e.g., data availability, subjective weighting, outdated indicators)
- Recommend the tool best suited to compare the six Latin American markets for Julius Meinl
- Format: max. 15 minutes and 15 slides, information-rich with clear visualizations
- Document all sources in a separate Excel sheet

Presentation 2: midterm

Part A: Market selection

- Compare the six countries using the same criteria
- Apply the tool chosen in the content presentation, transparently and replicably
- Rank the countries and justify the ranking
- Discuss the sensitivity of the ranking to criteria and weights
- Submit one Excel file and one presentation file; end with a justified recommendation

Part B: Market and competitor analysis

- Deep-dive into the assigned country
- Out-of-home and at-home coffee consumption
- Premium brands present and their prices
- Distribution in HoReCa and retail; import conditions
- Competitor positioning and communication
- Online analysis of the target city (menus, shelf prices, reviews, social media)

Presentation 3: marketing implementation plan

- Market entry and marketing plan for the assigned market: how the brand is marketed and how Julius Meinl enters the market
 - Target segment and first customers
 - Positioning, incl. the answer to the central question
 - Price positioning vs. competition
 - Distribution via a local partner, incl. a profile of a suitable partner
 - Communication and in-market activation (incl. creative implementation)
 - Rough timeline, first-year KPIs and key risks
- Format: max. 25 minutes

Assessment and organisation



Grading, schedule and rules

Grade components

- Content presentation (20 %)
- Midterm: market selection and competitor analysis (30 %)
- Final: marketing implementation plan (30 %)
- Self-reflection (10 %)
- Peer review (10 %)

Grading scale

- 1 (90–100 %)
- 2 (80–89 %)
- 3 (70–79 %)
- 4 (51–69 %)
- 5 (0–50 %)

Teaching schedule

Session	Topic	Student task
1	Course content and logistics	Prepare content presentation
2	Content presentation	Country comparison, selection model
3	Coaching session, progress report	Refinement and revision
4	Coaching session, progress report	Prepare midterm presentation
5	Midterm presentation	Assigned market, marketing plan
6	Coaching session, progress report	Refinement and revision
7	Coaching session, progress report	Prepare final presentation
8	Final presentation	Self-reflection, peer review

Data sources and framework conditions

- The project is based on publicly available data
- Julius Meinl provides no internal figures (revenues, margins, prices, partner names); none are needed
- **Possible sources:** USDA coffee country reports, coffee import trade statistics, national tourism statistics, public Julius Meinl material (corporate story, sustainability report, website)
- When contacting companies or individuals, act as students on a university project, not on behalf of Julius Meinl

AI, self-reflection and peer review

Use of AI

- Use of (Generative) AI tools is explicitly encouraged
- Tell a rich story in your presentations
- Be honest: list all tools you used
- Graded on quality, innovativeness and variety of sources

Self-reflection and peer review

- Self-reflection: one page on what you learned, what you liked and what can be improved
- Peer review: rate the engagement and performance of your group mates (not yourself); kept confidential
- Submit via Canvas until one week after the last session



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